COLD WAR END AND NEW WORLD ORDER

SOVIET COLLAPSE MECHANISM → AGENCY ABOVE AND BELOW → COLLAPSE CHRONOLOGY → YUGOSLAV BREAKDOWN → BOSNIA TO KOSOVO → EUROPEAN INTEGRATION LADDER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◈ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 SOVIET COLLAPSE MECHANISM

SOVIET COLLAPSE MECHANISM | PERFORMANCE LEGITIMACY FALLS | CRITICISM AND REFORM EXPAND | ALTERNATIVES ORGANISE | NON-USE OF FORCE | CONTROL BECOMES IRREVERSIBLE COLLAPSE | MUST REMEMBER | GORBACHEV'S REFORM PHASE, EASTERN EUROPEAN REVOLUTIONS OF 1989, GERMAN

STAGNATION → performance legitimacy falls → GLASNOST/PERESTROIKA → criticism and reform expand → NATIONALISM/YELTSIN → alternatives organise → NON-USE OF FORCE → control becomes irreversible collapse → MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, German unification in 1990

CORE CLAIM
- STAGNATION → performance legitimacy falls
- GLASNOST/PERESTROIKA → criticism and reform expand
- NATIONALISM/YELTSIN → alternatives organise

MECHANISM
- NON-USE OF FORCE → control becomes irreversible collapse
- MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, German unification in 1990
- and dissolution of the USSR in 1991 are distinct stages in the Cold

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- War's end.
- MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and
- German reunification in 1990, failed August 1991 coup and December Soviet dissolution are distinct stages.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and German reunification in 1990, failed August 1991 coup and December Soviet dissolution are distinct stages.

01

STAGE 01 AGENCY ABOVE AND BELOW

AGENCY ABOVE AND BELOW | REFORM AND RESTRAINT FROM ABOVE | RIVAL ELITE CENTRE | ORGANISED STRIKES FROM BELOW | STRUCTURE, CHOICE AND MOBILISATION CONVERGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above	SOLIDARITY → organised strikes from below	GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above
YELTSIN → rival elite centre	RESULT → structure, choice and mobilisation converge	YELTSIN → rival elite centre

CORE CLAIM
- GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above
- YELTSIN → rival elite centre

MECHANISM
- SOLIDARITY → organised strikes from below
- RESULT → structure, choice and mobilisation converge

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above
- YELTSIN → rival elite centre

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOLIDARITY → organised strikes from below; RESULT → structure, choice and mobilisation converge.

02

STAGE 02 COLLAPSE CHRONOLOGY

COLLAPSE CHRONOLOGY | GORBACHEV TAKES POWER | AUG 1988 | SOLIDARITY STRIKES IN POLAND | EASTERN EUROPEAN REGIMES COLLAPSE | USSR DISSOLVES; GORBACHEV RESIGNS

1985 → Gorbachev takes power → AUG 1988 → Solidarity strikes in Poland → 1989 → eastern European regimes collapse → 1991 → USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns

CORE CLAIM
- 1985 → Gorbachev takes power
- AUG 1988 → Solidarity strikes in Poland

MECHANISM
- 1989 → eastern European regimes collapse
- 1991 → USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1985 → Gorbachev takes power
- AUG 1988 → Solidarity strikes in Poland

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1989 → eastern European regimes collapse; 1991 → USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns.

03

STAGE 03 YUGOSLAV BREAKDOWN

YUGOSLAV BREAKDOWN | FEDERAL ORDER | LOSES COMMUNIST BINDING FRAMEWORK | MOBILISE AGGRESSIVE NATIONALISM | MIXED POPULATIONS | TERRITORIAL CLAIMS OVERLAP | WAR AND DISPLACEMENT DEEPEN

FEDERAL ORDER → loses communist binding framework → LEADERS → mobilise aggressive nationalism → MIXED POPULATIONS → territorial claims overlap → HESITATION → war and displacement deepen

CORE CLAIM
- FEDERAL ORDER → loses communist binding framework
- LEADERS → mobilise aggressive nationalism

MECHANISM
- MIXED POPULATIONS → territorial claims overlap
- HESITATION → war and displacement deepen

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FEDERAL ORDER → loses communist binding framework
- LEADERS → mobilise aggressive nationalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIXED POPULATIONS → territorial claims overlap; HESITATION → war and displacement deepen.

04

STAGE 04 BOSNIA TO KOSOVO

BOSNIA TO KOSOVO | YUGOSLAV WARS AND ETHNIC CLEANSING | DAYTON SETTLES BOSNIA | DISPUTES REMAIN | KOSOVO CRISIS AND NATO INTERVENTION

1991-95 → Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing → 1995 → Dayton settles Bosnia → BOUNDARIES → disputes remain → 1999 → Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention

CORE CLAIM
- 1991-95 → Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing
- 1995 → Dayton settles Bosnia

MECHANISM
- BOUNDARIES → disputes remain
- 1999 → Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1991-95 → Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing
- 1995 → Dayton settles Bosnia

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARIES → disputes remain; 1999 → Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention.

05

STAGE 05 EUROPEAN INTEGRATION LADDER

EUROPEAN INTEGRATION LADDER | ECSC POOLS STRATEGIC INDUSTRY | TREATY OF ROME CREATES EEC | FIRST ENLARGEMENT | MAASTRICHT CREATES DEEPER EU FRAMEWORK

1951-52 → ECSC pools strategic industry → 1957 → Treaty of Rome creates EEC → 1973 → first enlargement → 1992-93 → Maastricht creates deeper EU framework

CORE CLAIM
- 1951-52 → ECSC pools strategic industry
- 1957 → Treaty of Rome creates EEC

MECHANISM
- 1973 → first enlargement
- 1992-93 → Maastricht creates deeper EU framework

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1951-52 → ECSC pools strategic industry
- 1957 → Treaty of Rome creates EEC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1973 → first enlargement; 1992-93 → Maastricht creates deeper EU framework.

06

STAGE 06 DEEPENING VERSUS WIDENING

DEEPENING VERSUS WIDENING | POLITICAL AND MONETARY AUTHORITY EXPANDS | MORE STATES ENTER | FORMER COMMUNIST STATES JOIN | SOVEREIGNTY AND UNEQUAL ECONOMIES PERSIST

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands	2004 → former communist states join	DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands
WIDENING → more states enter	TENSION → sovereignty and unequal economies persist	WIDENING → more states enter

CORE CLAIM
- DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands
- WIDENING → more states enter

MECHANISM
- 2004 → former communist states join
- TENSION → sovereignty and unequal economies persist

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands
- WIDENING → more states enter

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2004 → former communist states join; TENSION → sovereignty and unequal economies persist.

07

STAGE 07 NEW-ORDER CLAIM

NEW-ORDER CLAIM | USA APPEARS SOLE SUPERPOWER | CONSENT REMAINS INCOMPLETE | UN AUTHORITY STILL MATTERS | UNIPOLAR MOMENT, CONTESTED ORDER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower	INSTITUTIONS → UN authority still matters	CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower
LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete	VERDICT → unipolar moment, contested order	LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete

CORE CLAIM
- CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower
- LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete

MECHANISM
- INSTITUTIONS → UN authority still matters
- VERDICT → unipolar moment, contested order

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower
- LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INSTITUTIONS → UN authority still matters; VERDICT → unipolar moment, contested order.

08

STAGE 08 WAR-ON-TERROR SEQUENCE

WAR-ON-TERROR SEQUENCE | 11 SEPT 2001 | TRANSNATIONAL ATTACK | TALIBAN REGIME TARGETED | DISPERSED NETWORKS BECOME CENTRAL | IRAQ 2003 | INTERVENTION DIVIDES THE ORDER

11 SEPT 2001 → transnational attack → AFGHANISTAN → Taliban regime targeted → SECURITY → dispersed networks become central → IRAQ 2003 → intervention divides the order

CORE CLAIM
- 11 SEPT 2001 → transnational attack
- AFGHANISTAN → Taliban regime targeted

MECHANISM
- SECURITY → dispersed networks become central
- IRAQ 2003 → intervention divides the order

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 11 SEPT 2001 → transnational attack
- AFGHANISTAN → Taliban regime targeted

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SECURITY → dispersed networks become central; IRAQ 2003 → intervention divides the order.

09

STAGE 09 IRAQ LEGITIMACY TEST

IRAQ LEGITIMACY TEST | US-UK CAPACITY TO INVADE | NO CLEAR SECURITY COUNCIL BASIS | INSTITUTIONAL DISAGREEMENT | CAPABILITY CANNOT MANUFACTURE LEGITIMACY | CLOSE DISTINCTION | ECONOMIC STAGNATION, NATIONALITY PRESSURES, LEGITIMACY LOSS, ARMS BURDENS, REFORM | WESTERN PRESSURE NOR ONE LEADER ALONE IS SUFFICIENT.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
POWER → US-UK capacity to invade	LESSON → capability cannot manufacture legitimacy	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion and diplomacy interacted
AUTHORISATION → no clear Security Council basis	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform choices and international diplomacy interacted	Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.
RESULT → institutional disagreement	neither Western pressure nor one leader alone supplies a sufficient cause.	

CORE CLAIM
- POWER → US-UK capacity to invade
- AUTHORISATION → no clear Security Council basis
- RESULT → institutional disagreement

MECHANISM
- LESSON → capability cannot manufacture legitimacy
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform choices and international diplomacy interacted
- neither Western pressure nor one leader alone supplies a sufficient cause.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion and diplomacy interacted
- Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.

10

STAGE 10 ARAB SPRING DIVERGENCE

ARAB SPRING DIVERGENCE | DEC 2010 | PROTESTS BEGIN IN TUNISIA | COMMON GRIEVANCE | UPRISINGS SPREAD | RESPONSE CAPACITY DIFFERS | EXTERNAL ROLE | OUTCOMES DIVERGE SHARPLY

DEC 2010 → protests begin in Tunisia → COMMON GRIEVANCE → uprisings spread → STATE/ARMY → response capacity differs → EXTERNAL ROLE → outcomes diverge sharply → EVIDENCE LIMIT: The post-1991 order combined a US-led unipolar moment with EU integration, globalisation, regional

CORE CLAIM
- DEC 2010 → protests begin in Tunisia
- COMMON GRIEVANCE → uprisings spread
- STATE/ARMY → response capacity differs

MECHANISM
- EXTERNAL ROLE → outcomes diverge sharply
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: The post-1991 order combined a US-led unipolar moment with EU integration, globalisation, regional wars
- and continuing Russian, Chinese and Global South agency, so neither final-peace nor Western-teleology claims are safe.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: The Gulf coalition displayed US-led unipolar capability, while Yugoslavia,
- NATO controversy, unequal globalisation and continuing Global South and Indian agency deny final-peace or Western-teleology claims.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NATO controversy, unequal globalisation and continuing Global South and Indian agency deny final-peace or Western-teleology claims.

11

STAGE 11 NEW WORLD ORDER ANSWER SPINE

NEW WORLD ORDER ANSWER SPINE | STAGNATION, REFORM, MOBILISATION AND RESTRAINT | YUGOSLAV FRAGMENTATION PLUS EU ENLARGEMENT | US PREDOMINANCE TESTED BY TERROR AND IRAQ | NO LINEAR DEMOCRATIC OR UNIPOLAR SETTLEMENT

COLLAPSE → stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint → EUROPE → Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement → ORDER → US predominance tested by terror and Iraq → VERDICT → no linear democratic or unipolar settlement

CORE CLAIM
- COLLAPSE → stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint
- EUROPE → Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement

MECHANISM
- ORDER → US predominance tested by terror and Iraq
- VERDICT → no linear democratic or unipolar settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COLLAPSE → stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint
- EUROPE → Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → no linear democratic or unipolar settlement.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | LOWE'S POST-1991 RUSSIA SECTIONS ARE ESPECIALLY USEFUL FOR MAINS | OF COMMUNISM DID NOT AUTOMATICALLY CREATE A HEALTHY DEMOCRACY | LOWE DOES NOT TREAT YUGOSLAVIA AS AN INEVITABLE EXPLOSION | MILOSEVIC'S SERBIAN NATIONALISM, TUDJMAN'S CROATIAN NATIONALISM, BOSNIA'S MIXED DEMOGRAPHY | INTERNATIONAL RESPONSE WAS LATE, HESITANT AND INCONSISTENT BEFORE NATO | BOSNIA AND KOSOVO ARE BEST REMEMBERED AS TESTS OF | LOWE NARRATES 9/11, AFGHANISTAN AND IRAQ IN DETAIL.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Lowe's post-1991 Russia sections are especially useful for Mains because they show that the collapse
- of communism did not automatically create a healthy democracy or a fair market economy .
- Lowe does not treat Yugoslavia as an inevitable explosion of "ancient" hatred.
- Milosevic's Serbian nationalism, Tudjman's Croatian nationalism, Bosnia's mixed demography and the weakness of compromise made violence more likely.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- International response was late, hesitant and inconsistent before NATO acted more decisively.
- Bosnia and Kosovo are best remembered as tests of post-Cold-War Europe and the UN, not just Balkan history.
- Lowe narrates 9/11, Afghanistan and Iraq in detail.
- CAUTION: He also includes a strong critical discussion of American foreign policy and whether state violence can itself be called terrorism.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: For UPSC, treat that section as historiographical debate , not as an unqualified fact to parrot.
- CAUTION: The safer exam line is: the Iraq War damaged the legitimacy of the post-Cold-War order because the justifications became heavily disputed.
- CAUTION: The Arab Spring is Lowe's reminder that authoritarian collapse does not by itself settle the problem of legitimate order.
- 25 June 2025, NATO Hague Summit Declaration: allies committed by 2035 to invest 5% of GDP annually

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels